



ART EXHIBITION

Folk Lure

The Great Indian Desert is an enchanting depiction and presentation of Rajasthani themes. This creative outpouring brings alive on canvas the social concerns and artistic sensibilities on issues of women, children, poverty, development and environment of Kiran Soni Gupta. Her faith in humanity is a source of inspiration. From sketches, pen and ink works to mixed media, she gives new dimensions to art forms, both traditional and modern. Her book *Kiran's Art Renderings* will also be launched on inauguration day. From September 22 to 30, at Chitramayee State Gallery of Fine Arts, Hyderabad. *by Amarnath K. Menon*

FILM REVIEW

CHINTUJI

Real Funny

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Director: Ranjit Kapoor

Starring: Rishi Kapoor, Kulraj Randhawa

There's a lovely scene in this satire on Bollywood and politics where an item girl has just finished swaying her hips to an African-themed song that rattles off names of cinematic greats. Hitchcock, Akira Kurosawa, Vittorio De Sica, Brian de Palma, sings Sophie Chaudhry. Rishi Kapoor, playing an ageing hero in a tribal leader costume, utters the final word with a thump of his spear: Satyajit Ray. Kapoor plays Chintuji, somewhat similar to his real self, an actor who comes to his accidental birthplace, a place called Hadbahi, to build his credentials to be an MP. Here he meets a microcosm of modern India. A young man on the run

from the police who thinks he was involved in the attack on Parliament. A doctor who dreams who's a closet scriptwriter. A PR professional who lives by spin. A power broker who bribes celebrities to join his patron's party. But Kapoor is the main attraction. He's the kind of guy who cheats at snakes and ladders, cannot do without his whisky, calls his producer darling, and wants to know how much higher his 35-foot cutout is compared to Amitabh Bachchan and Rajnikant. It's also the kind of film where hurt actors sport bandages on their shirtsleeves rather than their skin. Low on budget it may be, but it's big on heart. And laughs.

by Kaveree Bamzai

FILM REVIEW

Director: Shashanka Ghosh

Starring: Rajendra Prasad, Nasser

Some things are best left in the past. The southern cowboy, our very own vegetarian Clint Eastwood, was a refreshing voice in post-liberalisation India, one of the first times we learnt to laugh at ourselves. *Murugun* was an amalgamation of everything over the top in southern cinema, from swiveling bullets to flying cigarettes. Unfortunately, nostalgia is not enough to sustain a full-length film. *Murugun*, the leopard skin underwear-clad saviour, is engaged in a fight to death with Rice Plate Reddy, the Big Boy of the

ilaaka. Funny? You would think so, particularly with Mango Dolly (Rambha), a bottle blonde who makes hurried bandages out of her bandage dress, and Locket Lover (aka Lola Kutty), who speaks to our hero from a locket. There's much ditsy dialogue: one character is called Langoori Lafange. Another is called Kamine Kurkure. And a lot of layered comment on the McDosa-isation of south Indian food. In between, villains threaten to make Egyptian mummies out of Indian mummies and Dr Django tries to threaten Dolly Mango, but really it becomes quite a bore. Not even a sign announcing the Institute of Coconut Tree Climbing can save the day.

-KB



QUICK GUN MURUGUN

We Mind It

RATING ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆